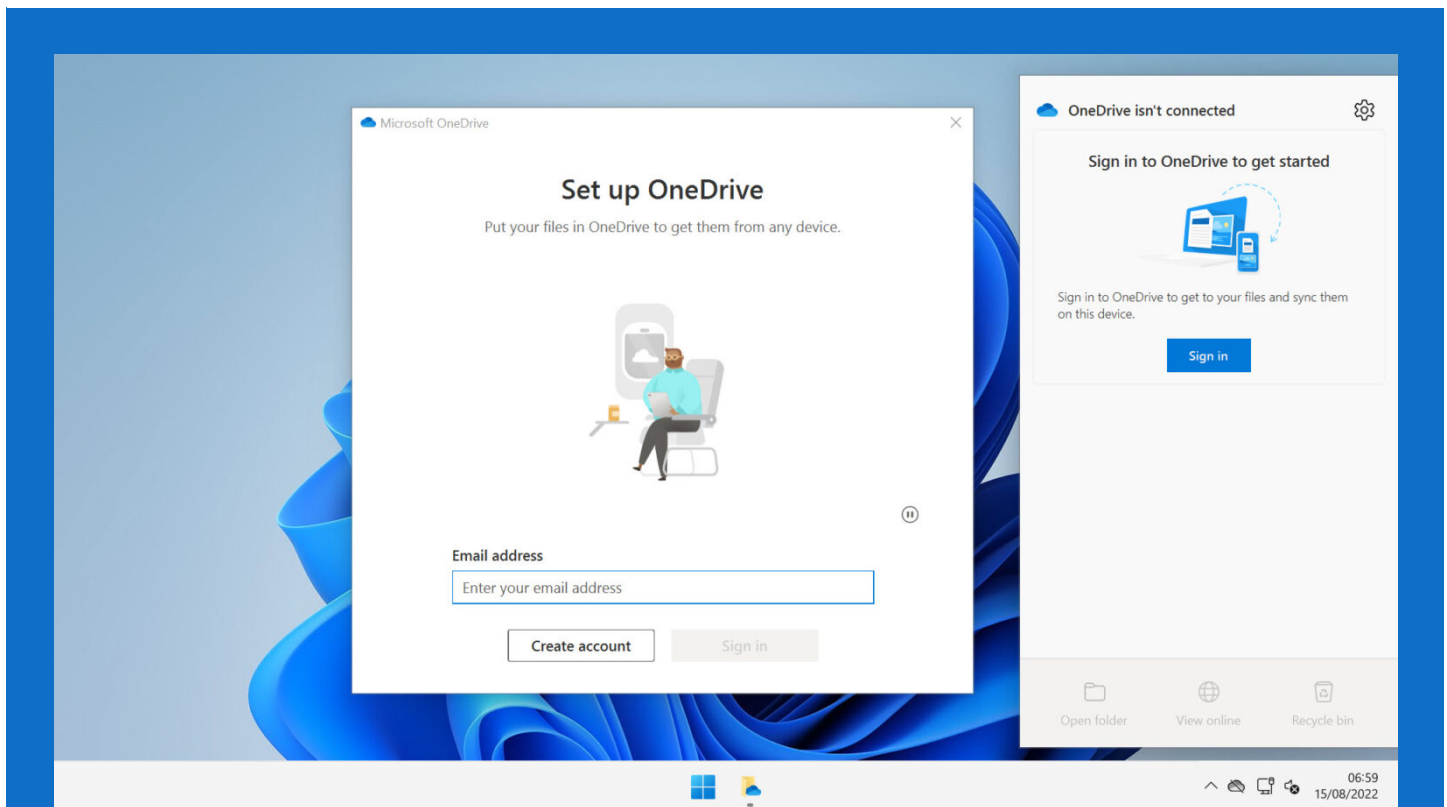


HOW TO INSTALL AND SET UP ONEDRIVE FOR FILE BACKUP AND SYNC ON WINDOWS



CARTER VERMULLEN

Introduction

This document focuses on the installation and configuration of OneDrive on a Windows PC. It provides step-by-step guidance on how to install the OneDrive desktop application, sign in with a Microsoft account, and configure sync and backup settings. The purpose of this document is to ensure that users with little to no technical background can successfully set up OneDrive for file backup and synchronization. By following this guide, users will be able to back up and access files across all their devices.

Primary Audience: The primary audience for this document includes students, professionals, and general users who need to set up OneDrive for file backup and sync but have little to no technical experience.

Secondary Audience: The secondary audience includes users who are already familiar with OneDrive but may need assistance with specific setup, sync settings, or troubleshooting issues.

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Step-by-Step Instructions

I. GETTING STARTED

A. PURPOSE OF THE GUIDE

This guide is designed to help users install, configure, and use OneDrive for file backup and synchronization on a Windows PC. It provides clear, step-by-step instructions to ensure a smooth setup process, even for those with minimal technical knowledge.

B. BENEFITS OF USING ONEDRIVE FOR BACKUP AND SYNC

OneDrive simplifies file management by providing secure cloud storage, ensuring files are backed up and accessible from any device. It reduces the risk of data loss due to hardware failure while enabling seamless file synchronization across multiple devices. Users can free up local storage space with on-demand files, collaborate in real-time using Microsoft 365 apps, and easily share files with others while maintaining control over permissions. Additionally, version history and recovery options allow users to restore previous file versions or recover deleted files if needed.

C. SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS FOR ONEDRIVE

To install and use OneDrive, a Windows PC must meet the following minimum requirements:

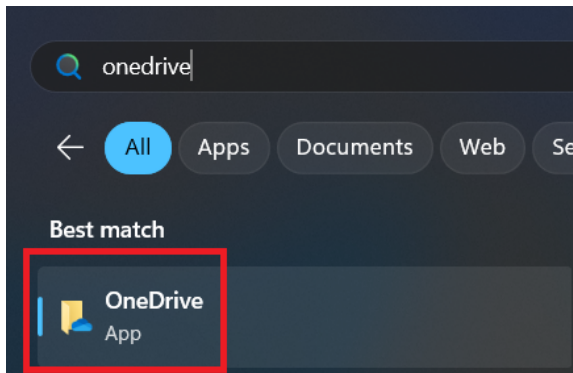
- **Operating System:** Windows 10 or later.
- **Storage Space:** Sufficient free space for installation and locally synced files.
- **Internet Connection:** Required for downloading, signing in, and syncing files.
- **Microsoft Account:** Necessary for accessing OneDrive services; this can either be a personal account or a work/school account that you have been provided.

For more specific details on system requirements, search for “**Microsoft Support OneDrive system requirements**” online or go to the following URL: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/onedrive-system-requirements-cc0cb2b8-f446-445c-9b52-d3c2627d681e>.

II. DOWNLOADING AND INSTALLING ONEDRIVE

A. CHECKING IF ONEDRIVE IS PREINSTALLED

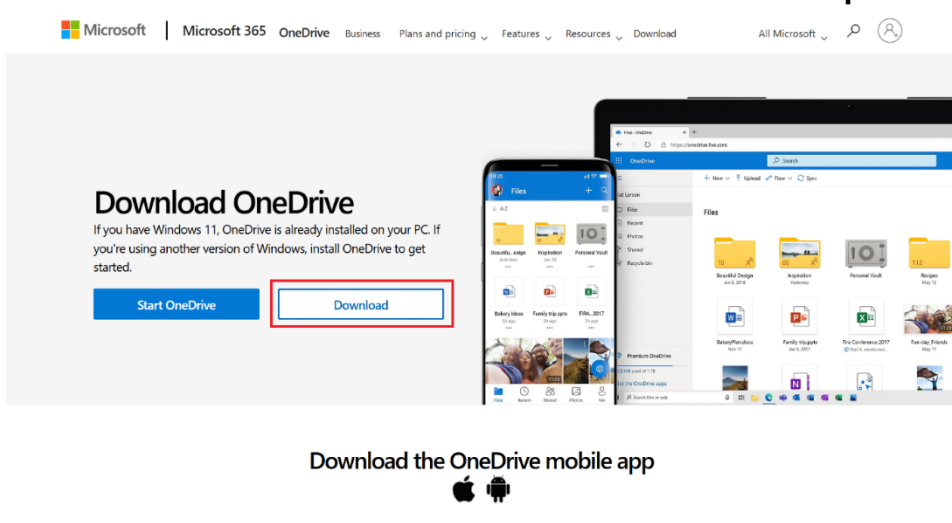
1. Click the **Start menu** or press **Windows + S** to open Windows Search.
2. Type “**OneDrive**” in the search bar.
3. Look for the **OneDrive app** with a blue cloud icon inside a folder, as shown in the image below.



4. If OneDrive appears, it is already installed, and you can proceed to **Section III: Signing into OneDrive**.
5. If OneDrive is not found, proceed to the next step to download it.

B. DOWNLOADING ONEDRIVE FROM MICROSOFT’S WEBSITE

1. Open a web browser and go to Microsoft’s OneDrive Download page. You can find this page by searching for “**OneDrive app download**” or going to the following URL: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/onedrive/download>.
2. Click the **Download** button to download the **OneDriveSetup.exe** file.



3. Wait for the download to complete before proceeding to the next step.

C. INSTALLING ONEDRIVE ON WINDOWS

1. Navigate to the folder where **OneDriveSetup.exe** was downloaded.
2. Double-click **OneDriveSetup.exe** to start the installation.
3. Click **Yes** when prompted by the **User Account Control (UAC)** window.
4. Wait for the installation to complete. The setup window will close automatically when finished.
5. Once installed, proceed to **Section III: Signing into OneDrive** to setup your account.

III. SIGNING INTO ONEDRIVE

A. OPENING THE ONEDRIVE APPLICATION

1. Locate the **OneDrive icon** in the **system tray** on the taskbar.
2. Click on it to open the **OneDrive system tray window**.



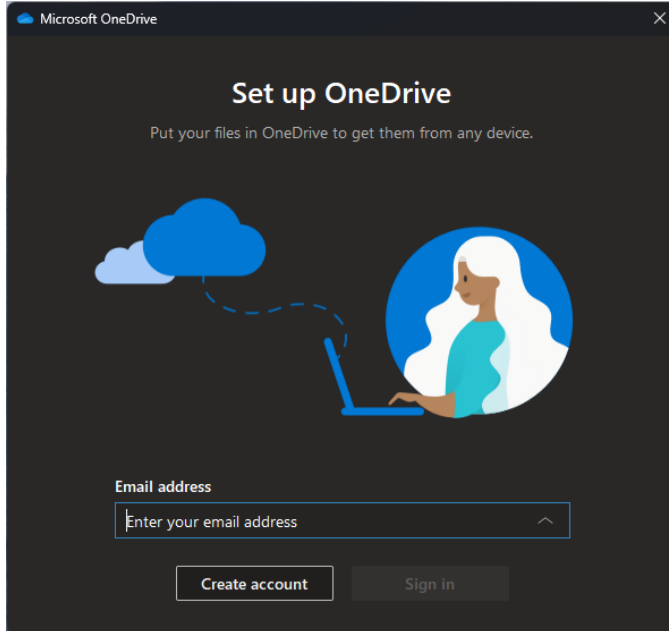
NOTE: If the OneDrive icon is missing, OneDrive may be in the **hidden icons menu**. You can access hidden system tray icons by clicking on the arrow circled in blue in the figure above. If OneDrive isn't showing up in the hidden icons menu, it may not be running. Open it from the **Start menu** or **restart your PC**.

B. ENTERING MICROSOFT ACCOUNT CREDENTIALS

1. Click the **Sign in** button in the OneDrive system tray window.



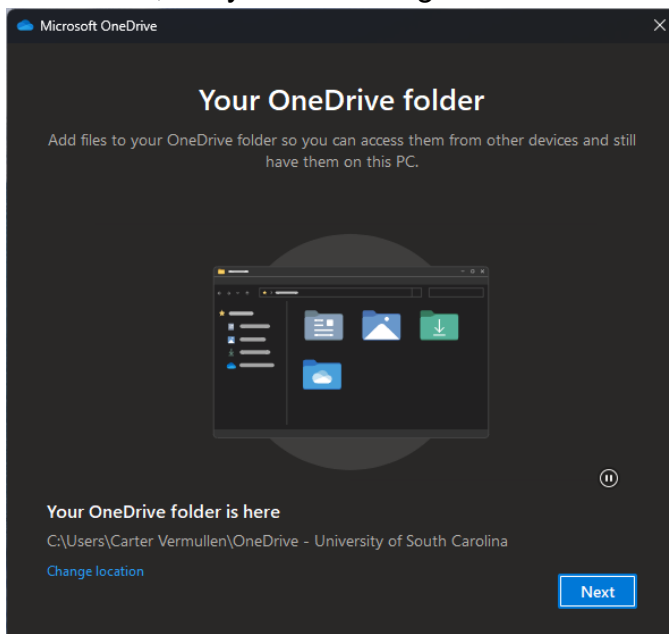
2. Enter your **Microsoft account email address** and click **Sign in**.



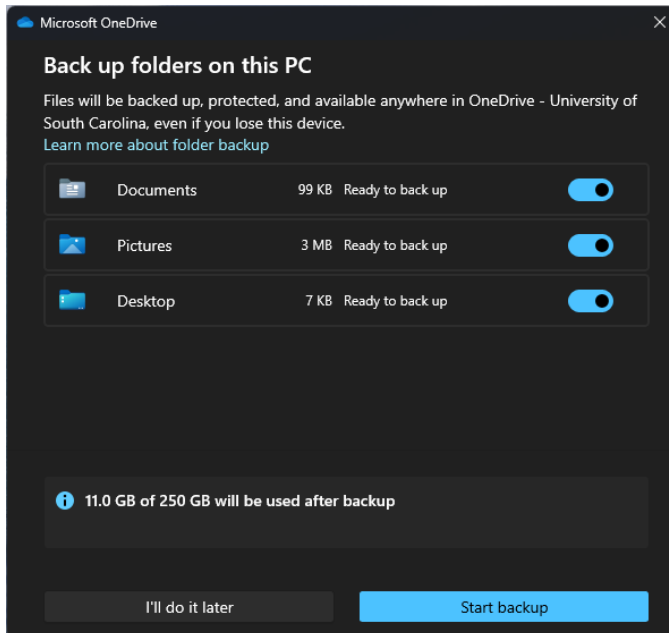
3. Enter your **password** and click **Sign in**. You may have to provide an additional form of authentication based on how your account is set up.
4. Windows may prompt you with the option to “**automatically sign in to all desktop apps and websites on this device.**” You can choose **Yes** to sign in across all apps or **No** to limit the sign-in to OneDrive.

C. SETTING UP INITIAL SYNC PREFERENCES

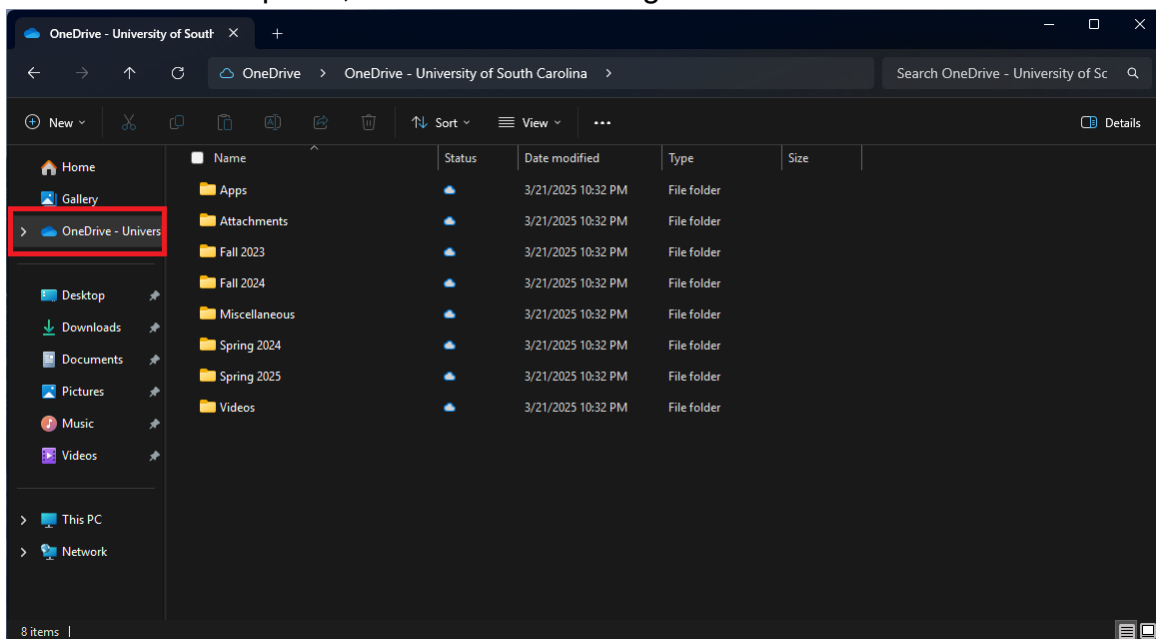
1. Choose the **OneDrive folder location** on your PC. The default location is inside your user folder, but you can change it if needed. Click **Next** to proceed.



2. Toggle which **local PC folders** (Desktop, Documents, and Pictures) to back up and then click **Start backup**. If you don't want to back up any of these folders, you can click **I'll do it later**. These settings can be changed later in OneDrive settings.



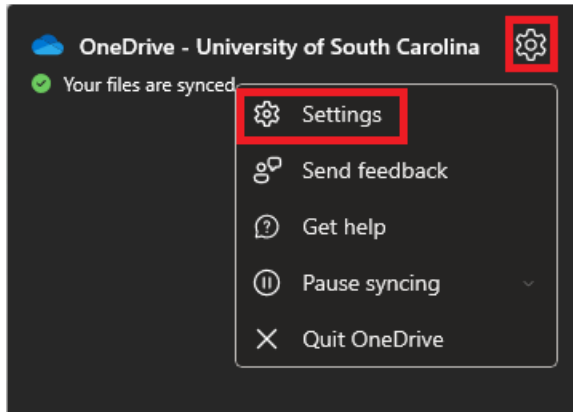
3. OneDrive will display a brief overview of its features. Click **Next** to move through the different sections.
4. When prompted to **get the mobile app**, you can choose **Later** to skip this step.
5. Once setup is complete, you'll see the message **"Your OneDrive is ready for you."** Click **Open my OneDrive folder** to access it in **File Explorer**.
6. You can quickly access the OneDrive folder anytime by clicking **OneDrive** in the **left sidebar** of File Explorer, as shown in the image below.



IV. CONFIGURING BACKUP AND SYNC SETTINGS

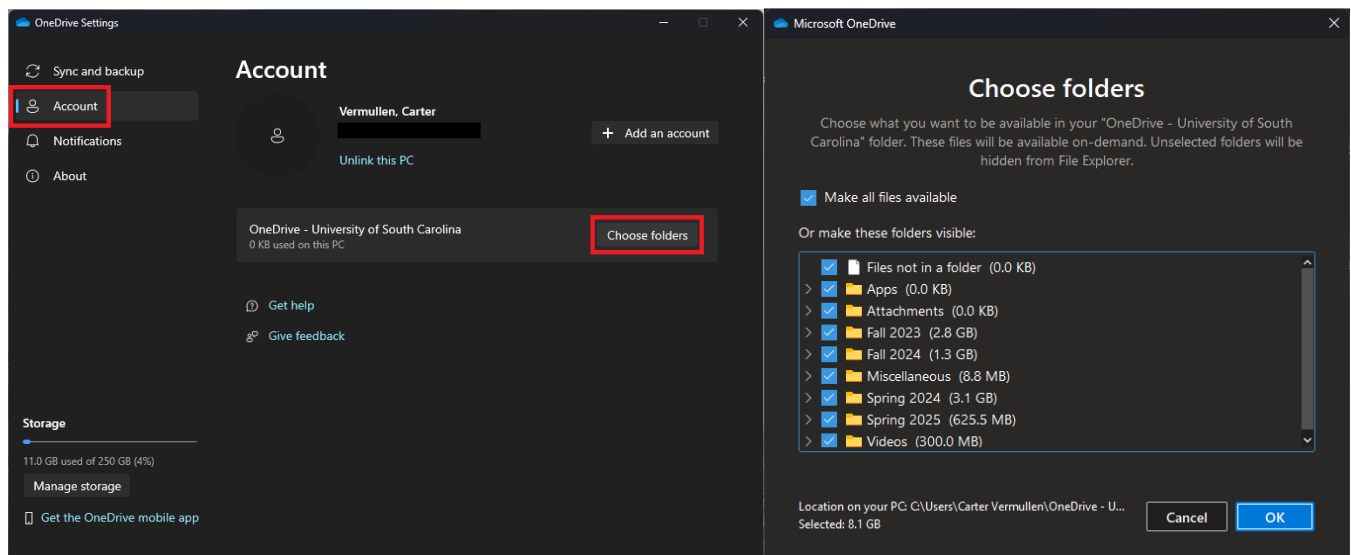
Opening OneDrive Settings:

1. Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
2. Select the **Help & Settings** (gear) icon.
3. Click **Settings** to open the OneDrive settings window.



A. SELECTING FOLDERS TO SYNC

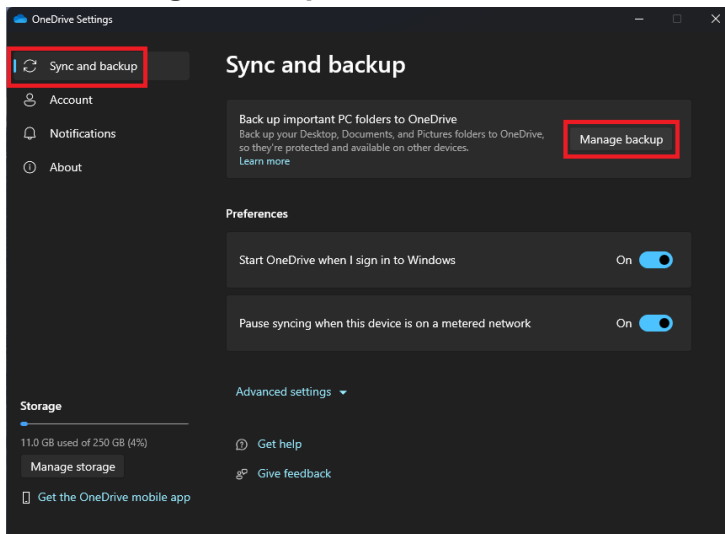
1. In OneDrive Settings, go to the **Account** tab.
2. Click **Choose folders**.
3. In the **Choose Folders** dialog box, uncheck any folders you don't want to sync to your computer.
4. Click **OK** to save your changes.



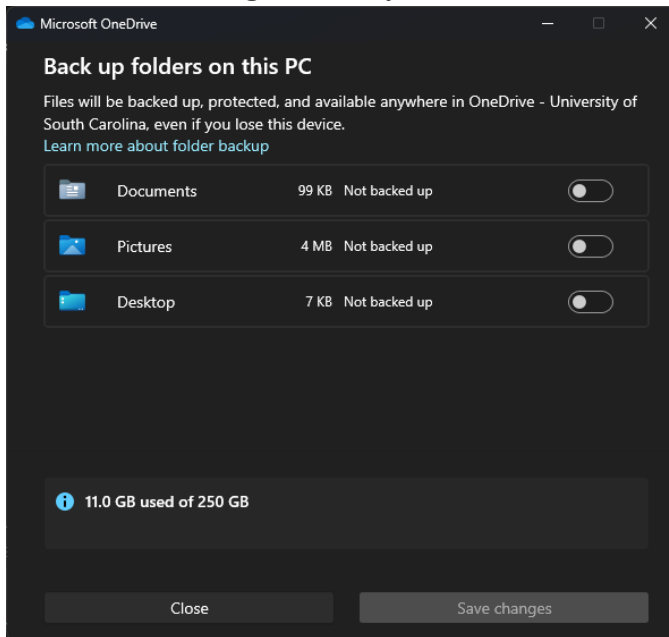
NOTE: Unchecking a folder removes it from your computer, but it remains available online in OneDrive.

B. ENABLING BACKUP FOR DESKTOP, DOCUMENTS, AND PICTURES

1. In OneDrive Settings, go to the **Sync and backup** tab.
2. Click **Manage backup**.



3. To start backing up a folder, toggle any folder labeled **Not backed up**.
4. To stop backing up a folder, toggle the switch off.
5. Click **Save changes** once you're finished.



C. UNDERSTANDING ON-DEMAND FILES VS. LOCALLY STORED FILES

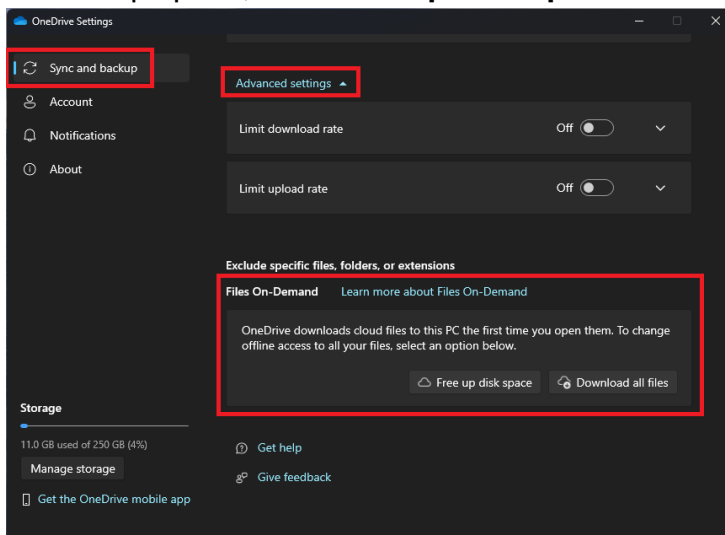
OneDrive Files On-Demand allows you to access all your OneDrive files without taking up storage on your computer. This feature is enabled by default.

Understanding File Status Icons:

- **Online-only (Blue cloud icon):** These files don't take up space on your computer and are downloaded only when opened. They require an internet connection to access.
- **Locally available (Green check icon):** Opening an online-only file downloads it to your device, making it available offline. You can free up space by right-clicking the file and selecting **Free up space** to revert it to online-only.
- **Always available (Green circle icon with white check mark):** Files marked as **Always keep on this device** remain downloaded and accessible offline, taking up space on your device. You can make a file always available by right-clicking the file and selecting **Always keep on this device**.

To Make All Files Available Offline or Revert Back to Online-Only:

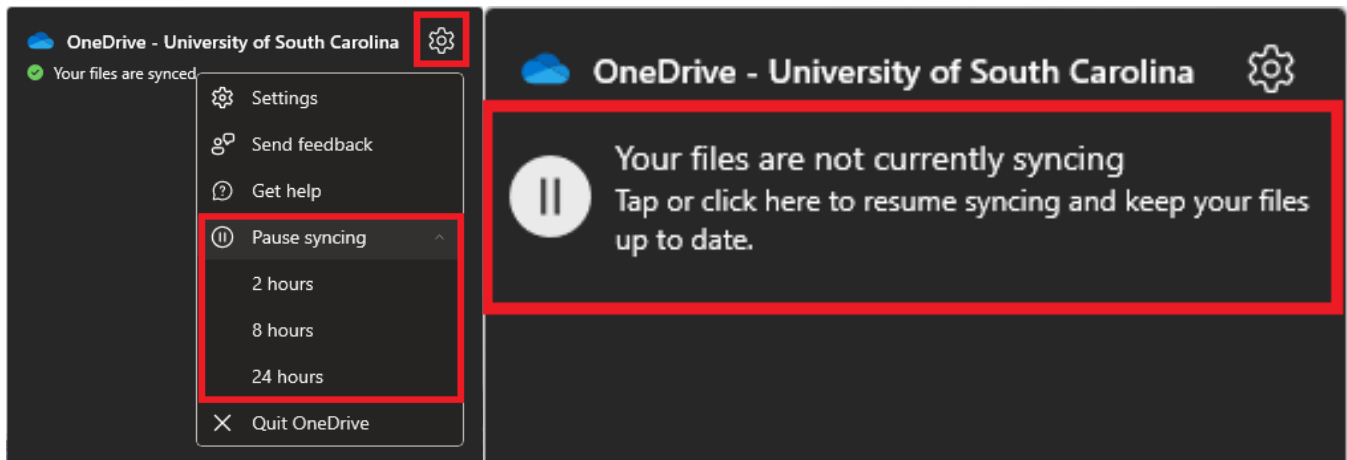
1. Open OneDrive Settings, and go to the **Sync and backup** tab.
2. Expand **Advanced settings**.
3. Click **Download all files** to store all OneDrive files locally.
4. To free up space, click **Free up disk space** to return files to online-only.



V. CONTROLLING ONEDRIVE SYNC AND STORAGE

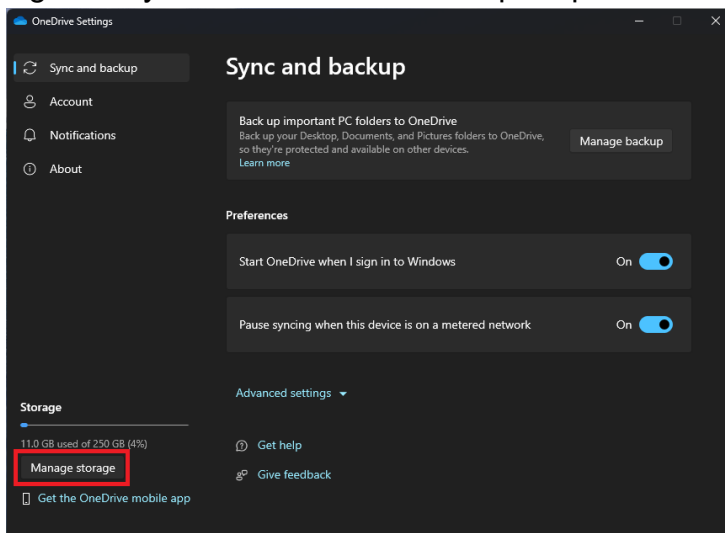
A. PAUSING AND RESUMING SYNC

1. Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
2. Select the **Help & Settings** (gear) icon, then click **Pause syncing**.
3. Choose a pause duration (2 hours, 8 hours, or 24 hours).
4. To resume, click the OneDrive cloud icon again and select the **“Your files are not currently syncing”** message to **resume syncing**.



B. CHECKING STORAGE QUOTA AND UPGRADING PLANS

1. Open OneDrive Settings.
2. Your available storage is displayed on the left side of the settings window.
3. Select **Manage storage**. This will take you to the OneDrive website; you may have to sign in to your Microsoft account if prompted.



4. OneDrive will show your largest files sorted by size, allowing you to manage space.

Largest files in your OneDrive | To free up space, download and delete files you don't need, and empty your [recycle bin](#).

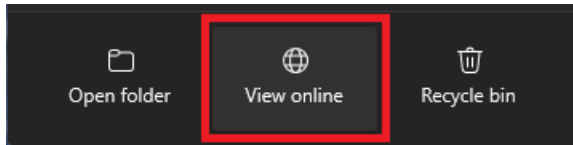
Name	Modified by	Modified	File size
CA_Module_4_for_students.pptx	Vermullen, Carter	1/23/2024	517 MB
CA_Module_3_for_students.pptx	Vermullen, Carter	1/16/2024	433 MB
Carter Vermullen - Final Presentation.mp4	Vermullen, Carter	12/6/2023	271 MB
Motherboard Setup-11052023.mp4	Vermullen, Carter	11/7/2023	269 MB

NOTE: If you are using a personal OneDrive account, you can click **Get more storage** to explore different storage plans from Microsoft.

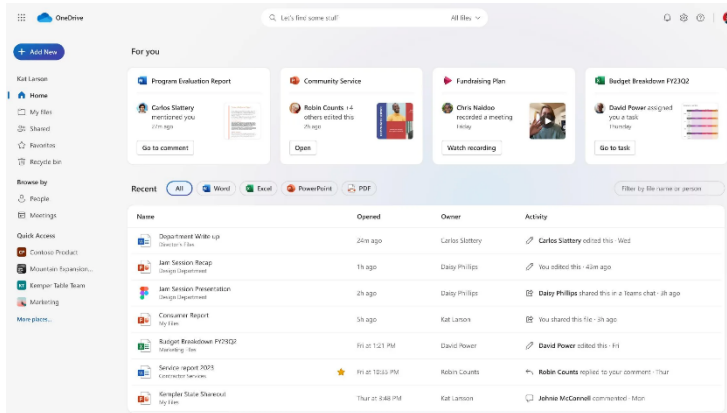
VI. ACCESSING FILES ON DIFFERENT DEVICES

A. USING ONEDRIVE WEB ACCESS

1. Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
2. Select **View Online** to open OneDrive in a web browser.



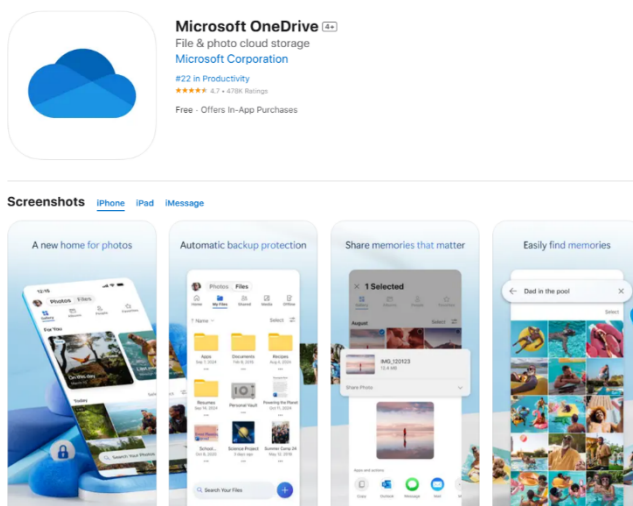
3. Sign in with your Microsoft account if prompted.



NOTE: The OneDrive website allows you to browse, download, upload, and manage your files from any device with an internet connection. You can access this website on other devices by using the following URL: <https://onedrive.live.com/login>.

B. ACCESSING FILES ON MOBILE DEVICES

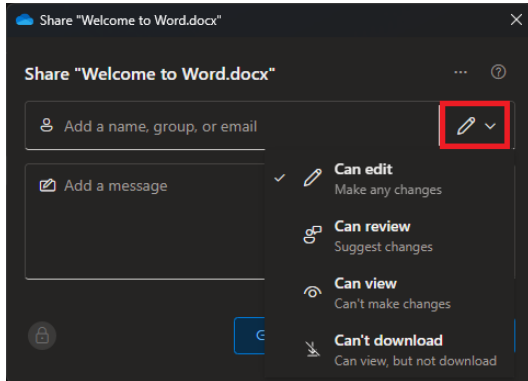
1. Open the **App Store (iOS)** or **Google Play Store (Android)**.
2. Search for **OneDrive** and download the app.
3. Open the app and sign in with your Microsoft account.
4. You can now access, upload, and manage your files directly from your mobile device.



C. SHARING FILES AND FOLDERS WITH OTHERS

Sharing with Specific People:

1. **Right-click** a file or folder in **File Explorer** and select **Share**.
2. In the **Name, group, or email field**, type the email addresses or names of the people you want to share the file or folder with.
3. Click the **pencil icon** to adjust permissions; see the figure below.



4. Click **Send** to email the link to the specified recipients. If needed, you can later manage access to remove or change permissions for people.

Sharing with a Link (Copy Link Option):

1. **Right-click** a file or folder in **File Explorer** and select **Share**.
2. Click the **Link settings** button (gear icon) next to the Copy link button to adjust who can access the file or folder:
 - a. **Anyone:** Creates a public link that anyone can access (not recommended unless necessary).
 - b. **People in [Your Organization]:** Allows access to anyone within your company or school.
 - c. **People with existing access:** Generates a link for users who already have access, without changing permissions.
 - d. **People you choose:** Restricts access to only the specified recipients.
3. Click **Apply**, then select **Copy link**.



4. Paste the link into an email or message to share it. If needed, you can later manage access to change settings or delete the link.

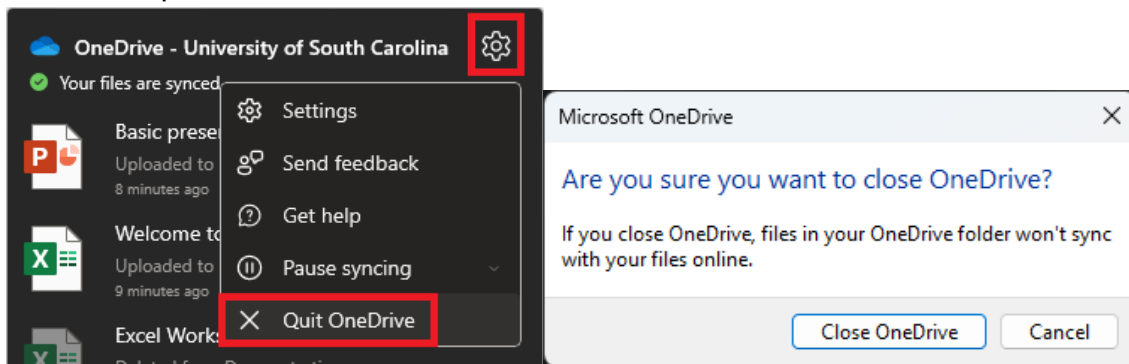
VII. TROUBLESHOOTING COMMON ONEDRIVE ISSUES

A. FIXING GENERAL SYNC ERRORS

If OneDrive is stuck on the syncing status icon or files are not uploading properly, try the following steps:

1. **Quit OneDrive and Restart It:**

- Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
- Select the **Help & Settings** (gear) icon, then click **Quit OneDrive**.
- Click **Close OneDrive** on the confirmation message.
- Reopen OneDrive from the **Start** menu.



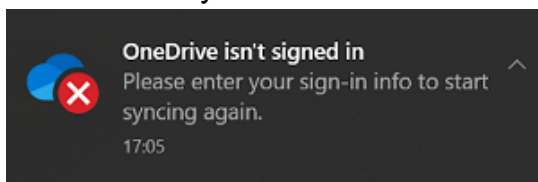
2. **Restart Your PC:** If quitting OneDrive doesn't resolve the issue, restart your computer and check if syncing resumes.

For additional troubleshooting steps, see Microsoft's Support Article – **Fix OneDrive Sync Problems:** <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/fix-onedrive-sync-problems-0899b115-05f7-45ec-95b2-e4cc8c4670b2>.

B. FIXING ONEDRIVE ISN'T SIGNED IN ERROR

If OneDrive signs you out or stops syncing due to a recent password change, follow these steps:

1. **Look for the Notification:** You may receive a “OneDrive isn't signed in” notification or notice that your OneDrive folder is not updating with changes.



2. **Sign Back In:**

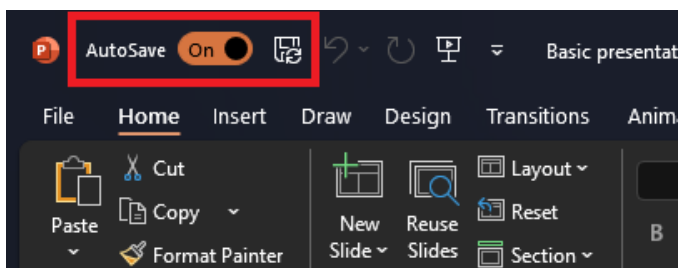
- Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
- Select the **Sign in** button in the “**Start syncing again by signing in**” message.
- Enter your **Microsoft account credentials** and follow the prompts to sign back in.

VIII. ONEDRIVE INTEGRATION WITH MICROSOFT 365 (OFFICE) APPS

A. AUTOSAVE IN MICROSOFT 365 APPS

OneDrive enables **Autosave**, which automatically saves changes to your documents in **Microsoft 365 apps like Word, Excel, and PowerPoint** in real time. This feature ensures that your progress is continuously saved, preventing data loss.

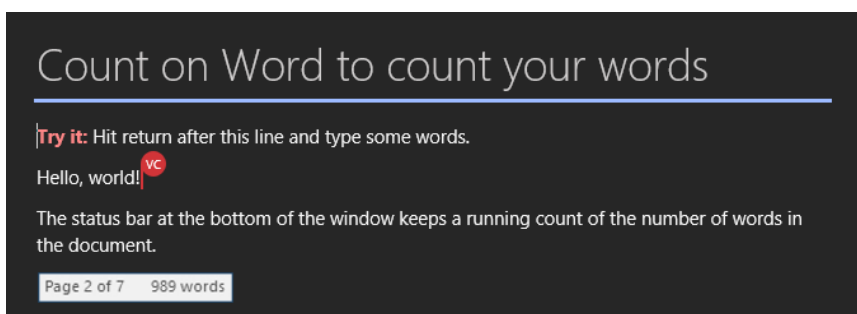
- **Autosave Toggle:** You can turn Autosave **on or off** using the **toggle switch** in the upper-left corner of Office app windows; refer to the image below for reference.
- **File Versioning:** OneDrive keeps track of previous versions of your files, allowing you to **restore earlier versions** if needed. For instructions on restoring previous versions of files, refer to **Section IX: Backup and Recovery Options in OneDrive**.



B. REAL-TIME COLLABORATION IN MICROSOFT 365 APPS

OneDrive allows **multiple users to edit a document simultaneously**, making collaboration seamless in Microsoft 365 apps.

- When a document is shared, you can see the **initials or profile pictures** of others working in the file, along with **real-time text updates** showing where they are typing; refer to the image below for reference.
- If changes from others aren't appearing, **click the Save button**. It also functions as a refresh button to update the document with the latest edits.
- For instructions on sharing documents, refer to **Section VI: Accessing Files on Different Devices**.

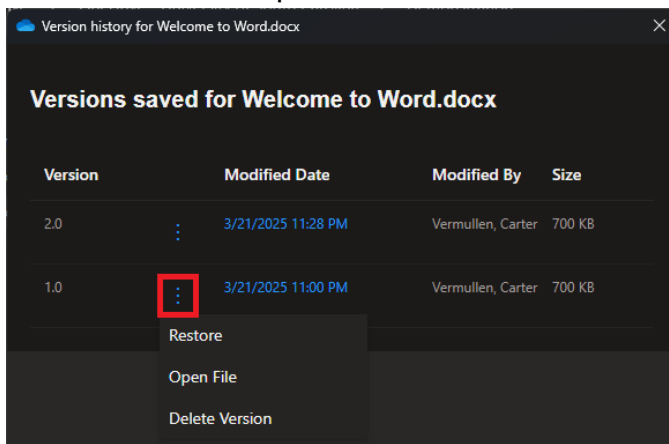


IX. BACKUP AND RECOVERY OPTIONS IN ONEDRIVE

A. RESTORING PREVIOUS VERSIONS OF FILES

OneDrive keeps **version history** for files, allowing you to **revert to earlier versions** if needed.

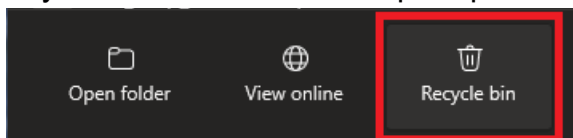
1. In **File Explorer**, right-click the file you want to restore and select **Version history** from the menu.
2. A list of previous versions will appear. Click the **three dots** next to the version you want to restore.
3. Click **Restore** to replace the current version with the selected one.



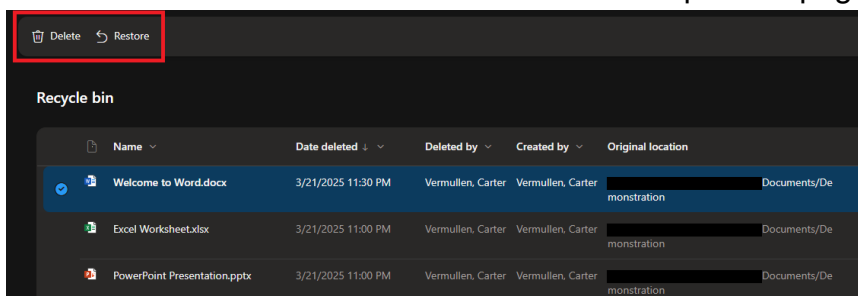
B. RECOVERING DELETED FILES FROM ONEDRIVE RECYCLE BIN

If you accidentally delete a file, OneDrive stores it in the **Recycle Bin** for a limited time before permanent deletion.

1. Click the OneDrive cloud icon in the system tray.
2. Select **Recycle bin**. This will take you to the OneDrive website; you may have to sign in to your Microsoft account if prompted.



3. Select the file(s) you want to restore.
4. Click the **Restore** button on the toolbar at the top of the page.



X. FINAL STEPS AND RESOURCES

A. FINAL CHECKLIST FOR ONEDRIVE SETUP

Before finishing, review these key steps to ensure the OneDrive Windows client is set up correctly and you understand everything:

- ✓ **Sign in to OneDrive** with your Microsoft account.
- ✓ **Set up automatic backup** for Desktop, Documents, and Pictures folders (if needed).
- ✓ **Understand file status icons** to differentiate online-only, locally available, and always-available files.
- ✓ **Ensure OneDrive starts with Windows** to keep files syncing automatically.
- ✓ **Review folders syncing to OneDrive** in File Explorer to confirm files are being stored in OneDrive.
- ✓ **Check storage usage** and manage large files if needed.

B. BEST PRACTICES FOR ONEDRIVE MANAGEMENT

To keep OneDrive running and efficiently manage your workflow, follow these tips:

- **Keep OneDrive running** – ensure the OneDrive system tray icon is visible and active.
- **Use Pause Sync** to temporarily stop syncing during heavy network usage or when making large file changes.
- **Quit and restart OneDrive** if sync issues occur or files aren't updating as expected.
- **Monitor storage space and manage large files** through OneDrive Settings > Manage Storage.
- **Use the Save button in Office apps** as a refresh option when collaborating on shared documents.
- **Check the OneDrive Recycle Bin** for any deleted files you may need before they are permanently removed.

C. ADDITIONAL RESOURCES AND SUPPORT

For more help and detailed guides, visit Microsoft's **OneDrive Help & Learning** page:

<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/onedrive>.

Closing Remarks

Congratulations on setting up OneDrive on your Windows PC! You should now have a fully configured system that automatically syncs and backs up your files, allowing you to access them from any device. With OneDrive, you can ensure your important files are always available, collaborate in real time, and restore previous versions if needed.

To maintain a smooth experience, keep OneDrive running, monitor storage usage, and check sync status regularly. If you ever need additional help, refer to the OneDrive support page for troubleshooting and best practices.

Frequently Asked Questions

DO I NEED TO MANUALLY UPLOAD FILES TO ONEDRIVE, OR DOES IT SYNC AUTOMATICALLY?

Once OneDrive is set up and running, it automatically syncs any files placed in the OneDrive folder on your PC. If you've enabled **PC folder backup**, it will also sync your Desktop, Documents, and Pictures folders without needing to move files manually. However, if OneDrive isn't running or is paused, changes won't sync until it resumes.

CAN I ACCESS MY ONEDRIVE FILES IF I'M OFFLINE?

Yes, but only files that are stored locally on your device. Files marked with a cloud icon are online-only and require an internet connection to open. You can right-click a file and select **Always keep on this device** if you need offline access.

WHAT HAPPENS IF I DELETE A FILE FROM ONEDRIVE?

When you delete a file from OneDrive, it moves to the OneDrive Recycle Bin, where it stays for up to 30 days (or 93 days for work/school accounts). You can restore it within this time, but after that, it's permanently deleted. If you delete a file while OneDrive is syncing, the deletion will also be reflected across all your connected devices.

CAN I USE ONEDRIVE ON MULTIPLE DEVICES?

Yes! OneDrive works across Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android. As long as you're signed in with the same Microsoft account, your files will sync across all devices. You can also access your files through the OneDrive website.

WHAT SHOULD I DO IF ONEDRIVE IS USING TOO MUCH BANDWIDTH AND SLOWING DOWN MY INTERNET?

You can temporarily **pause syncing** by clicking the OneDrive system tray icon and selecting **Pause syncing** for 2, 8, or 24 hours. If you need a more permanent fix, go to **OneDrive Settings > Sync and backup > Advanced settings** and limit the upload/download speed.